Fetal Heart Rate Patterns

Maternal & Newborn Health | Labor & Delivery

REMEMBER IT AS

VEAL CHOP

- **V - Variable decelerations = C - Cord compression**
  Reposition the client; check for cord prolapse.
- **E - Early decelerations = H - Head compression**
  Usually benign; keep monitoring.
- **A - Accelerations = O - OK**
  Reassuring fetal oxygenation.
- **L - Late decelerations = P - Placental insufficiency**
  Stop oxytocin, turn to the side, give IV fluids, notify the provider.

NURSE TIP

Late decelerations are never reassuring.